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‘It hit hard, because it just brought back a lot of memories.’

JOHN DOE 1, in a lawsuit filed against the Diocese of Providence

Decades after abuse, altar boys speak out

Priest allegedly brought children to cottage; bounced among parishes for years

By Amanda Milkovits
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — The five friends had grown up poor in the brick apartments of the Prospect Heights Housing Projects in Pawtucket, R.I. They all served as altar boys at the project’s church hall. And they all kept silent about the dark secret they shared for more than 50 years.

Sometime in the winter of 1973

and 1974, the Rev. Armand Ventre, the priest from St. Teresa of the Child Jesus who led Mass in Prospect Heights, invited one of the boys to visit his cottage on Lake Washington in northwest Rhode Island. Ventre asked him to invite other boys, and his older brother and three friends soon visited the cabin, which the priest called “Virgin Wood.”

The property in Glocester, R.I.,

with its woods and gentle shore, was like paradise for children from the Pawtucket projects.

For more than 50 years, the five former altar boys didn’t discuss what happened to them at the idyllic cabin. But in March, Attorney General Peter F. Neronha announced the results of an investigation into how the Roman Catholic Diocese of Providence handled complaints of child sexual abuse go-

ing back to 1950. The five read the report, saw the section about Ventre, who died in 1999, and decided to break their silence.

“It hit hard, because it just brought back a lot of memories,” the man identified in a lawsuit as John Doe 1 said in an interview with the Globe. (The Globe does not identify alleged victims of sexual abuse without their permission.)

ABUSE, Page B4



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

First-year student Zara Mody was delighted to see the work of Dorm Essentials Co. on her new home at Boston University.

ROOM SERVICE

College students want just the right look, and they’ll pay for help from the pros

By Brooke Hauser
and Michaela Towfighi
GLOBE STAFF

Most first-year students moving into Boston University’s Sleeper Hall on Monday wrestled large blue rolling bins full of stuff into elevators as a marching band played “I’m Shipping Up to Boston.”

Not Zara Mody, an 18-year-old freshman from San Jose, Calif. She and her parents took a long walk around campus, and when they returned hours later, carrying a new BU sweatshirt and Dunkin’ iced coffee, it was to a dramatic dorm-room reveal.

“I literally don’t even know what to say — this is so perfect!” Mody squealed, taking in the pink-and-white palette that cheered up her side of a double. Her parents filmed her reaction as she hugged Kelly Mahoney and

Kerry Giordano, who run Dorm Essentials Co. and had spent the morning creating Mody’s new home away from home.

Like many of Dorm Essentials’ clients, Mody discovered the Reading-based duo on Instagram, where students across the country show off once-monastic spaces transformed into cozy bedrooms complete with fabric headboards, cloud-like duvets, swag curtains, and their names in fluorescent lights.

Nowhere is the trend of the luxury dorm makeover bigger than in the South, where it has reached debutante heights. It’s a thing in New England, too, just more . . . New Englandy.

Welcome to back-to-school season, when thousands of college students stream back into residence halls around the state. While

many are leaving the look of their rooms to fate by scavenging shelves at Target, others are going all out with a little help from regional businesses like Dorm Essentials, big stores like Pottery Barn Teen, or, in some cases, even their parents’ personal interior decorators.

College students are expected to spend a record \$103.5 billion on back-to-school shopping this year, according to the National Retail Federation. But even those on a shoestring budget can access bespoke dorm designs through artificial intelligence tools like VisualizeAI and RoomsGPT, which allow users to upload photos and reimagine their spaces within seconds. Or they get their ideas from Instagram, TikTok, and YouTube.

DORMS, Page A7

Meta to pay \$18b over teen addiction

Agrees to new limits on Instagram, Facebook use; Mass. will get up to \$516m

By Dana Gerber and Paul Heintz
GLOBE STAFF

Teenage users of Instagram and Facebook will face stringent new limits on when and how they can engage with the popular social media sites, part of a landmark settlement their corporate parent struck with Massachusetts and dozens of other states.

Technology giant Meta also agreed to pay up to \$18 billion to 52 states, territories, and Washington, D.C., the tech giant announced Wednesday.

The deal came after multiple states sued, accusing Meta of designing its platforms to deliberately addict young users so they spend more time online. The agreement comes after some of those states went to trial in federal court in California last week.

The new conditions include a limit of two hours a day for teens up to age 18 on both platforms, which cannot be lifted without a parent’s approval, according to Meta. The company also agreed to block access from midnight to 6 a.m., and silence notifications between the school hours of 8 a.m. to 3 p.m. (Direct messaging is exempt from these limits, “to allow teens to stay connected with friends and family,” Meta said.)

Among other changes: teen users will be pre-

META, Page A7

So far, Markey dodges gotcha moment on age

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

It was a moment that Representative Seth Moulton’s Senate campaign had likely been waiting for. In the last televised debate between Moulton and Senator Ed Markey, the 80-year-old incumbent answered a question about his use of artificial intelligence in a way that felt rather, well, grandfatherly.

“I use whatever is inside my iPhone or my iPad, whatever comes up,” Markey answered.

In the moment, and then the days afterward, Moulton pounced. On stage, he cast Markey’s response as evidence of the need for “a new generation of leaders to regulate these technologies.” His campaign quickly spread the clip on social media and sent out a press release post-debate. Then came a digital ad recapping the moment, titled, “The future is now.”

Perhaps now more than ever, the nation’s aging political class is under renewed scrutiny, and Markey is not immune.

But while Moulton, 47, has made Markey’s age a central part of his “pass the torch” campaign, those potentially viral clips illustrating his argument on the need for generational change have been otherwise rare. Markey, across three debates, regularly jostled with his younger challenger, lobbed well-rehearsed retorts, and, last week,

SENATE, Page A6



Give us s’more

Thursday: Seasonable.
High 80-85. Low 68-73.

Friday: A little humid.
High 80-85. Low 62-67.

High tide: 11:37 a.m., 11:45 p.m.

Sunrise: 6:04 Sunset: 7:27

Weather and Comics, D5-6.

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Jurors in the Lindsay Clancy case are expected to begin deliberations today after hearing instructions on the law related to murder, mental illness, and criminal responsibility. **B1.**

The Postal Service can for now move ahead with plans to restrict mail-in voting before the midterm elections, after a federal judge lifted an order. **A2.**



Character actor Tim Curry died at 80. He was best known for his role as Dr. Frank-N-Furter in the cult film “The Rocky Horror Picture Show.” **C9.**

Massive flash floods in a border area of Nepal and China killed at least 160 people and left hundreds missing. **A3.**

Searching for common ground on vaccines

From an evangelical upbringing, she’s become voice of science — and empathy

This story is republished from STAT, the health and medicine news site that’s a partner to the Globe. It is part of a new STAT initiative to examine the roots and consequences of distrust in science.

By Felice J. Freyer
STAT

At the age of 23, Elisabeth Marnik approached her doctor with an unusual request: Vaccinate me. Against everything.

She had never received a single vaccine. But now, angry and defiant, she was turning away from the beliefs of her childhood, instilled by a mother who distrusted science. A doctor for adults doesn’t typically have childhood immunizations on hand, so she made her way to a travel clinic and eventually got all the once-forbidden shots.

A year would pass before she told her mother about the vaccines. And several more years would go by before Marnik came to have sympathy for her mother’s choices.

That happened, as it so often does, when Marnik became a mother herself, in 2019. A harrowing childbirth necessitated several blood transfusions. Overwhelmed and foggy-headed,

VACCINES, Page A10



Elisabeth Marnik, shown as a child, did not receive any vaccinations because her mother didn’t believe in them.